

BNRI — Investor One-Pager

Bemidji Neighborhood Renewal Incentive · RenewMyBlock

The opportunity

Bemidji's downtown housing core is aging, undercapitalized, and primed for a coordinated revitalization push. The BNRI program exists to make it economically rational for investors — REITs, funds, and private capital — to acquire, rehabilitate, and bring back to market homes inside the pilot zone (5th–15th Street, west of Irvine Avenue).

Target: 2,500 homes (~50% of city housing stock) over the program horizon.
Projected economic impact: \$300–500M by 2040.

Investor stack — what you actually get

- **10-year tax abatement** on the value of improvements (BNRI-specific)
- **~65% city fee waivers** on permits and plan review
- **2–3% BNRI financing** (below-market rate; structured through partner lenders)
- **\$10,000 grant** per qualifying home
- **48 pre-approved plans** (Phoenix Clean & Lean model) — accelerates plan review and reduces design cost
- **Vetted contractor pool** matched to investor by parcel volume and project type
- **City liaison** for 5+ parcel deals — direct line to the building department

What we are NOT pitching

Federal Opportunity Zone tax benefits. Beltrami County is not currently a federally designated Opportunity Zone (verified May 2026). Any BNRI material that references OZ deferral, step-up, or 10-year capital-gain exclusion is being corrected. If you are deploying OZ capital specifically, Bemidji is not the right fit — we're happy to be honest about that up front.

Why the math works in Bemidji

- **Acquisition costs are well below metro Minnesota** for comparable square footage.
- **ALICE-aligned rent ranges** (53% of Bemidji households fall under the ALICE threshold) — buy-to-rent investors hitting workforce-affordable rents may also qualify for state workforce-housing programs.

- **Storm rebuild momentum** — the June 2025 derecho (\$9.8M damage, 9M trees, FEMA denied) created an unusual concentration of replacement-ready properties.
- **Coordinated municipal partnership** — the city is actively recruiting investment, not resisting it.

The Concierge advantage

Every investor working with BNRI gets a single point of contact — the RenewMyBlock Concierge — who handles:

1. Parcel screening (in-zone verification, GIS pulls, title and lien diligence)
2. ROI modeling with the BNRI stack pre-applied
3. Contractor matching from the vetted pool
4. City liaison coordination for portfolio-scale deals
5. Abatement and grant enrollment paperwork

You stop chasing departments. We hand you a packet.

Next step

Send your acquisition criteria — target unit count, hold period, ROI threshold, geography preferences. We come back with parcels that fit, modeled with the BNRI stack applied.

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